

RUSHITA PALADUGU

Email: rushitasai@gmail.com

Education

University of Sussex – BA Politics and International Relations

Focus areas: **Political economy, governance, international policy**

Profile

Dedicated student of Politics and International Relations with a strong emphasis on governance, public policy, and reform. Experienced in conducting **policy research, advocacy**, and outreach through academic initiatives and nonprofit leadership roles. Competent in **comparative analysis, writing policy briefs, and communicating** effectively with **evidence-based approaches**. **Passionate** about driving meaningful change.

Key Skills

- Policy research & analysis (policy briefs, comparative politics, political economy)
- Advocacy & outreach (campaign design, stakeholder engagement)
- Quantitative & qualitative research (voter behaviour, case-based reasoning)
- Strategic communication & leadership (cross-cultural collaboration)
- Tools: R, Excel, Adobe Suite, Canva, Microsoft Office
- Languages: English - Highly fluent, Hindi

Experience

Head role— Women Empowerment Club (PINK) | Aug 2022 - till date

- Conducted grassroots campaigns on gender rights, microfinance, and digital literacy.
- Empowered rural communities through reform-oriented initiatives

Policy & Research Intern — Global Alliance of Innovative Learning (GAIL) | October 2023 - March 2024

- Coordinated international discussions on governance and community development.
- Produced comparative research insights for cross-cultural policy webinars.

Advocacy Intern — Dance4Healing | June 2024 - November 2024

- Designed campaigns framing mental health as a public policy issue, increasing engagement by 40%.
- Created data-driven reports to strengthen advocacy strategy.

Intern — Youth Action Hub India | September 2024- August 2025

- Designed and promoted the Campus Captains Program, engaging 60+ student leaders and promoting UN SDG campaigns.

Fellow — Youth Policy and Governance Forum | Online Program | December 2024 – February 2025

- Selected for a competitive fellowship on leadership, governance, and policy.
- Researched digital diplomacy and presented a cybersecurity policy pitch for developing nations.
- Networked with policymakers and young leaders from 20+ countries.

Policy Volunteer – Public Health Advocacy Campaign | March 2025 - May 2025

- Led outreach analysis for the Mental Health Access Brief 2024, synthesising input from students, families, and frontline workers into actionable insights.
- Contributed to a data-driven report highlighting long NHS wait times, rising youth distress, and service inequality across Brighton.
- Co-designed listening sessions with local youth groups, capturing urgent needs around early intervention, school-based support, and culturally competent care.
- Drafted key sections of the Council’s campaign brief and helped shape 3 core policy recommendations, including mobile mental health units and embedded school counsellors.

Selected Projects & Research

- **Policy Brief** — Climate Diplomacy in Emerging Economies (BRICS, energy security & climate finance)
- **Comparative Political Economy** — Growth Models & European Politics (Neimanns & Baccaro framework)
- **Electoral Behaviour in Europe** (quantitative analysis of volatility & cleavages using R/Excel)
- **Political Theory & Governance** (poverty & freedom, constructivism & diplomacy)
- **UN SDGs Memo** — Gender Equality (SDG 5) (comparative study: India, Sweden, Kenya)